CHANGES TO ECOSYSTEMS

This worksheet is about changes to ecosystems.

special words

ecosystem
environment
living things
non-living things

In worksheet 14.1 you learnt that an ecosystem is all the living and non-living things found together in an area. An ecosystem can be made up of many habitats.

Ecosystems may change. The changes can be caused by things such as floods, earthquakes, droughts and bushfires. Human beings may also cause changes.

Cutting down natural forests to build houses from the wood, building a freeway through the bush or putting up a large shopping complex are examples of some of the things that human beings do to their environment.



To do

1 Look at the picture of the Australian bush.

2 In the table write down the names of any living things that you find hidden in the drawing and any others that you can think of that might live in this ecosystem.

3 Now write down the names of any non-living things that you think would be in this ecosystem.

Living things	Non-living things

continued

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To do



4 In this table write down what would happen to each of the things that you have listed above when the following events happen:

- a freeway is built through the middle of the bush
- a near-by river floods the area
- a factory that makes chemicals used to kill insects and weeds is built in the middle of the bush
- all the trees are cut down to make into tables and chairs.

	Living things	Non-living things
Building a freeway		
A river flooding		
Building a chemical factory		
Cutting down all the trees		

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